
EARNKARO · SENIOR PM ASSIGNMENT

Segmentation and Personalization

Making one app feel like it was built for each of 3 million creators.

This is the answer to Question 1. It ships with a working, instrumented prototype (React) — the screenshots throughout are from it. Everything here is built on the real EarnKaro app and a clear point of view: the fix isn't five apps, it's one app that quietly knows who you are.

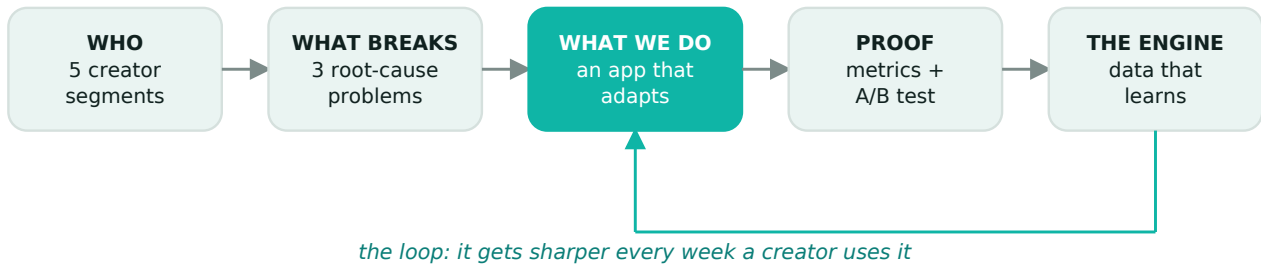
Prepared by Agniv

Includes: 5 segments · a root-cause audit · a segmented design · flow diagrams · a success and A/B framework · a data model · a live prototype.

THE SHORT VERSION

The whole answer, in one picture

EarnKaro has a three-million-creator problem hiding in plain sight: it treats them all the same. Rohit, who runs a 20,000-member Telegram deal channel, gets the exact same home feed as Sunita, who shares a few grocery deals with her family from home. The argument below runs left to right — and then loops, because the whole thing only works if it learns.



One root cause sits under all of it: the app is organised around its own objects — profit links, partner stores, a transactions ledger — not around the creator (their workflow, their audience, their goal). Fix that, and “built for me” stops being a slogan.

PART 1

Five creator segments

Segments are behavioural, not demographic. “Housewife” or “college student” are labels that sit on top of behaviour; the product should care about how someone actually shares. The clean cut is audience size × monetization intent.

The Deal-Broadcaster e.g. Rohit, runs a 20k Telegram channel

- Who: Runs broadcast channels; posts 30–100+ deals a day. Treats it as a side business.
- Primary goal: Throughput — turn trending deals into posts fast, before they expire.
- What motivates sharing: Money, directly: volume × conversion, and never missing a hot deal.
- A successful week: ~500 links, a few “hero” deals each driving hundreds of clicks, ₹3,000–10,000+.

The Instagram Influencer e.g. Aisha, 40k fashion followers

- Who: Curated niche audience; posts selectively; few shares, high trust per share.
- Primary goal: Earn from her audience without diluting her brand — on-brand products, shared natively.
- What motivates sharing: Money + reputation. She won’t post an ugly link or an off-brand product.
- A successful week: 10–25 curated links, 2–3 story sets, high conversion per link, no clutter.

The Casual Sharer e.g. Sahil, shares in his hostel WhatsApp

- Who: Student/young earner; low volume, opportunistic; came via a referral.
- Primary goal: A little side income with almost no effort; pocket referral bonuses.
- What motivates sharing: Easy money + social ease; saving on his own purchases.
- A successful week: 3–10 links, 1–2 conversions (often his own buys), ₹200–800.

The Power Affiliate e.g. Vikram, treats EK like a business

- Who: Multi-channel, data-driven, runs a referral downline. The top few percent.
- Primary goal: Optimise and scale earnings; grow the network; run EK like a dashboard.
- What motivates sharing: Income maximization + downline growth (the lifetime 10% cut).
- A successful week: 500+ links, deep analytics, ₹15,000+, and he knows why the number moved.

The Home Earner e.g. Sunita, earns from home in Bengaluru

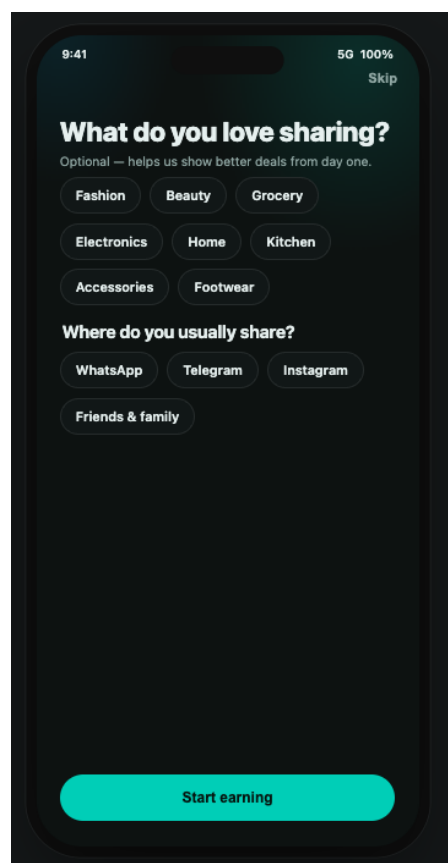
- Who: Homemakers/retirees in trusted groups; time-rich, tech-cautious, often vernacular.
- Primary goal: Reliable supplementary household income, with low complexity. Real money to her.
- What motivates sharing: Income + helpfulness; very sensitive to “will I actually get paid?”
- A successful week: 15–40 links in a few trusted groups, ₹800–3,000, paid without friction.

Which ones do we build for first?

We don't have EarnKaro's internal numbers, so the split below is an explicit estimate — but the point is to decide, not just describe.

Segment	Share of creators	Share of GMV	Role
Casual + Home Earner	Most by headcount	Low each	Top-of-funnel; referral engine; loyal base
Broadcaster	Small	High (volume × conv.)	Core GMV driver
Power Affiliate	Tiny	High	GMV + viral referral flywheel
Influencer	Mid	Medium	Brand credibility; pulls premium brands

Build order: Broadcaster first (biggest GMV lever, clear ROI on throughput) → Home Earner second (largest activation/retention base, cheapest to keep) → Influencer third (growth and brand). The Power Affiliate is mostly served by extending Broadcaster tooling plus a network dashboard.



The one question we ask up front — a soft, skippable signal, not an identity. Behaviour does the rest.

PART 2

Audit: the top 3 problems

Three structural problems — each hits one segment hardest, and each is a different face of the same root cause. (Observations are from the live EarnKaro app.)

Problem 1 — The unit is a profit link, not a ready post

Hits the Broadcaster

- What's actually happening: The app is built around "Make a Link." Rohit can browse deals right inside EarnKaro and copy a profit link, or paste any product URL into "Make Links" to convert it — so getting a link isn't the hard part. The problem is what he gets: a bare link, when his job is to publish a deal — an image, a line of copy, and the link, as one post. EarnKaro hands him the link and leaves the rest to him, by hand, one deal at a time: no one-tap "turn this deal into a post," no bulk convert, and a feed that isn't ranked by what's hot or about to expire. At 30–100 posts a day, that manual assembly is the ceiling.
- What it costs EK: A throughput ceiling on the highest-GMV segment, and a reason for power users to defect to third-party bots.

Problem 2 — Discovery is built around stores, not products

Hits the Influencer

- What's actually happening: The home feed is a wall of store-wide banners — "Myntra End of Reason 50–80%," "Flipkart June Epic Sale." The app's idea of "content" is which store has a sale. Aisha's idea of content is which specific product fits her audience. She has to dig through mega-sales to assemble something on-brand — and the clutter is exactly what she refuses to post.
- What it costs EK: The highest conversion-per-link segment under-shares or churns, and EK loses the brand credibility that attracts premium partners.

Problem 3 — Success is a backward ledger, not a forward goal

Hits the Home Earner (and the Power Affiliate)

- What's actually happening: Reports is a rear-view mirror: "₹30, Pending ₹30, Confirmed ₹0." It tells you what already happened. Nowhere is there a goal, a progress bar, or a "here's the one thing to do today." For Sunita — cautious, vernacular-first — the opaque "pending" states read as "will I even get paid?", and she quietly stops. (Vikram feels it too, and rebuilds tracking in a spreadsheet.)
- What it costs EK: EK leaks a huge, loyal, daily-active base at activation — the cheapest users to keep.

The through-line: one app means the Broadcaster is throttled, the Influencer is cluttered, and the Home Earner is intimidated. That is the real, evidence-backed version of "the product does not know who you are."

PART 3

A segmented experience

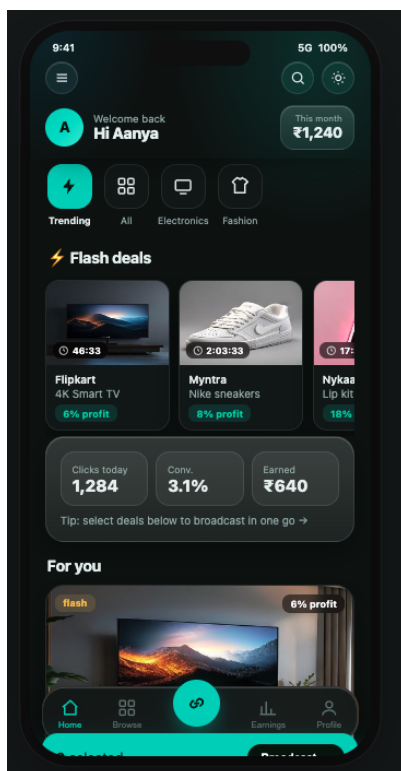
One important call first, because it's easy to get wrong: we do not put the segments in the UI. Nobody opens an app thinking "I am a Broadcaster," and a label you can't act on is noise. So the five segments are an internal lens. They show up in two invisible ways:

- Relevance — which deals and categories rise to the top, learned from behaviour.
- Progressive tools — the right tool simply appears: bulk + a clicks dashboard for a high-volume sharer, a story-card maker for an Instagram creator, a goal tracker for a goal-setter.

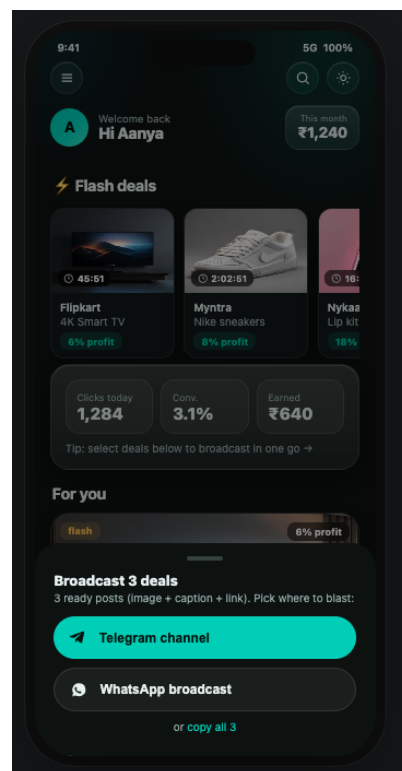
The only thing we ask up front is a soft, skippable interest signal, to make day one feel relevant before we have data. This is how Instagram and Amazon work — they infer, they don't interrogate. We still answer the literal brief: the home, the discovery, and the sharing tools genuinely differ by segment. Here's how.

Broadcaster — make the unit a post

- Home: a Hot and Expiring velocity feed (what should I post right now?).
- Sharing (the hero): one tap turns a deal into a ready post — image + caption + link — plus bulk select to fire off a dozen at once.



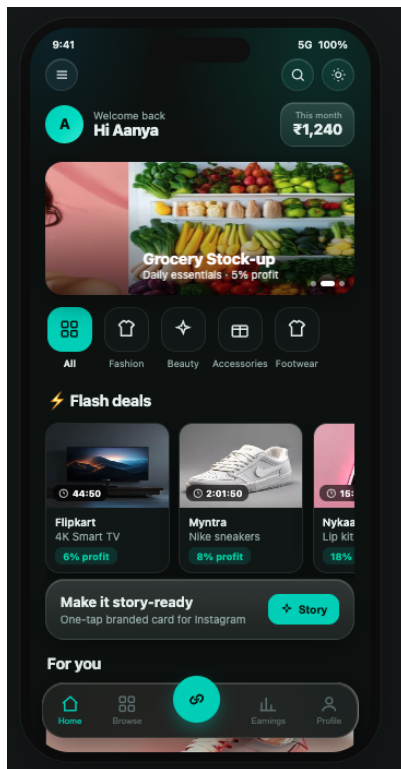
Broadcaster home: velocity feed, a live clicks dashboard, and a bulk bar — speed, not browsing.



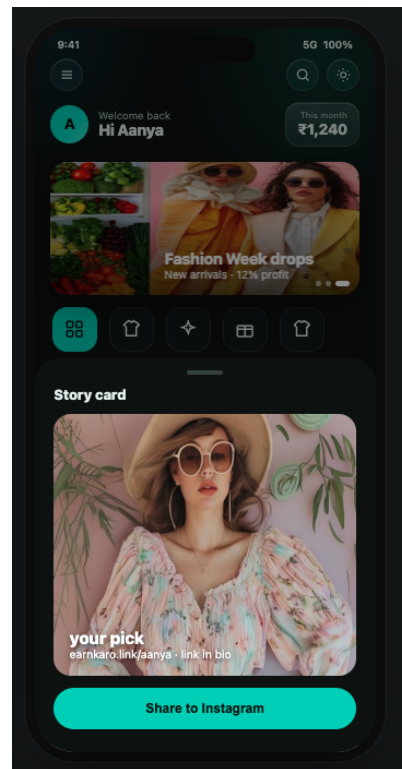
Bulk "Broadcast 3 deals" — ready posts handed straight to Telegram or WhatsApp.

Influencer — make the unit a product in her niche

- Home: a curated product board in her niche, not store sales.
- Sharing (the hero): a one-tap story card — a clean, on-brand image + a short link, ready for Instagram.



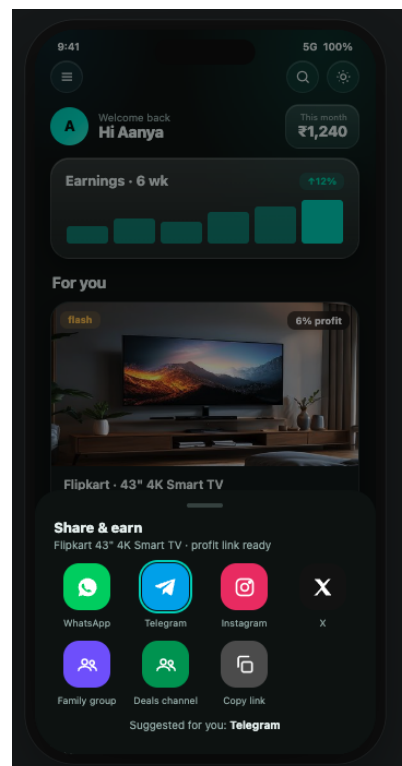
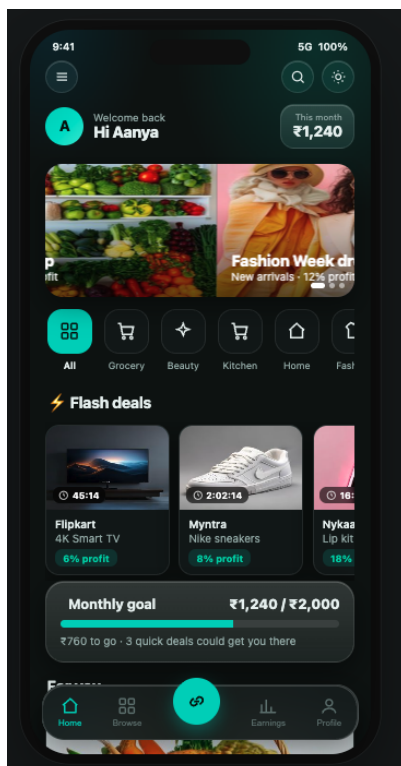
Influencer home: a product board with a “Create story card” tool front and centre.



The story card: a reputation-safe asset she can post in one tap.

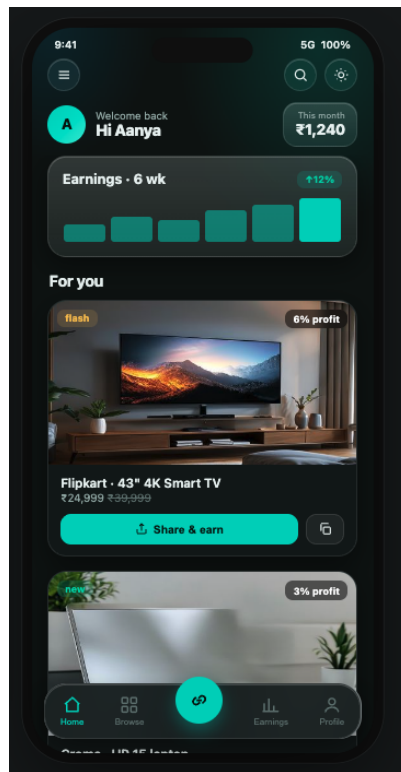
Home Earner — make the unit a step toward her goal

- Home: a monthly goal + progress bar + today's 3 picks, in plain language.
- Sharing: one tap to her saved Family group; payouts written like “₹30 — paid to you by the 7th,” not “pending.”



Home Earner: a goal she's chasing
and three things to do today.

The share sheet — with a
“suggested for you” default per
segment (here, Telegram).



Power Affiliate: the same app, now a dashboard — a 6-week earnings trend and performance up top.

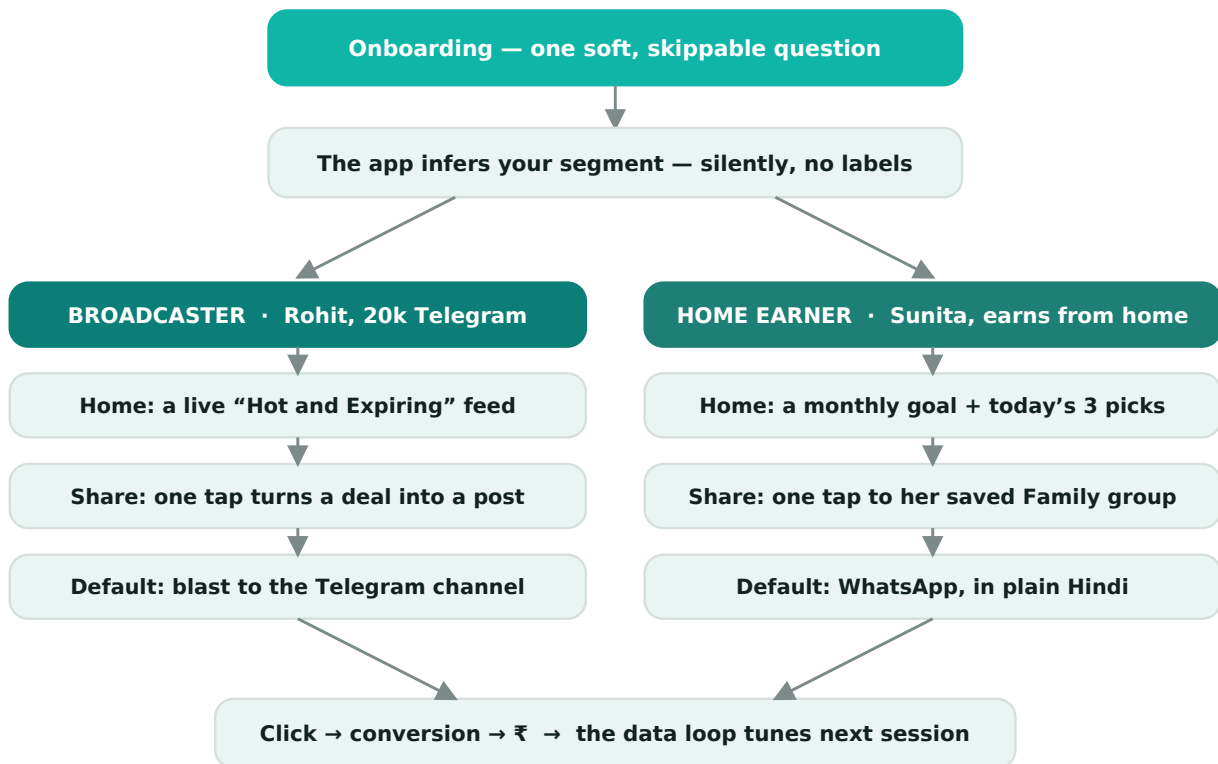
Why these are the right changes (not just nice ones)

Segment	Hero change	Impact / Effort	Beats... (and why)
Broadcaster	One-tap post + bulk	High / Med	A browser extension (off-app, more work) and a scheduler (doesn't fix throughput)
Influencer	Niche feed + story kit	High / Med	Creator analytics first — relevance matters more than charts for sharing
Home Earner	Goal + daily picks	High / Low	Vernacular-only — necessary, but guidance is the activation lever

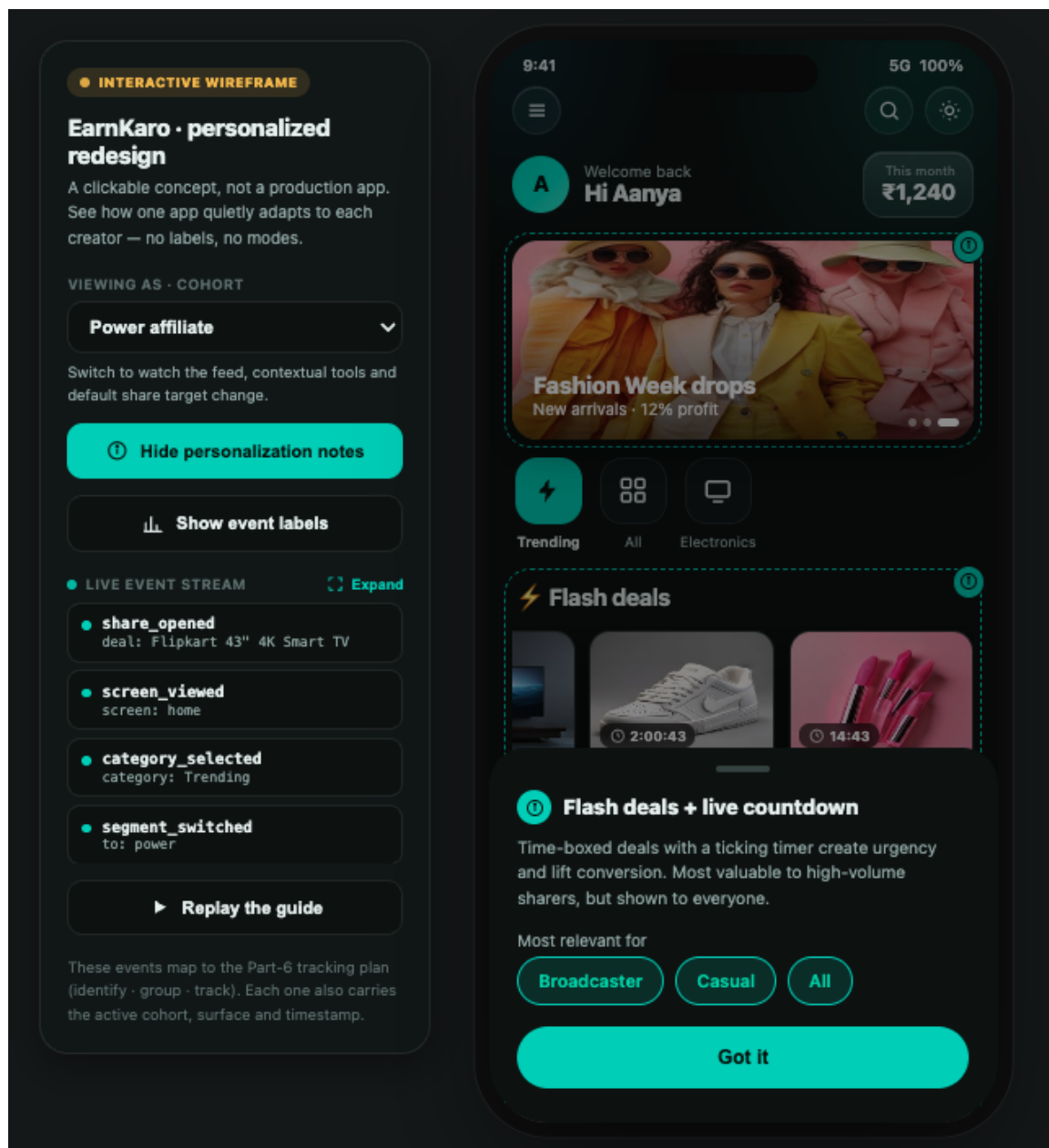
Each hero change lands on a different surface (sharing / discovery / home) and fixes a different root — no overlap, no wasted effort.

How the experience diverges — a flow

Same front door, same spine (top bar, nav, payments). One soft question routes two very different creators into two very different apps — then both feed the same learning loop.



And because this is a real prototype, every section can explain itself. Turn on “personalization notes” and each block tells you why it’s there and which segments it serves — including the honest cases (a flash-deal timer helps Broadcasters and Casual sharers, so it’s shown to everyone).



Tap any marker and the prototype explains the logic — here, why flash deals with a live countdown serve more than one segment.

PART 5

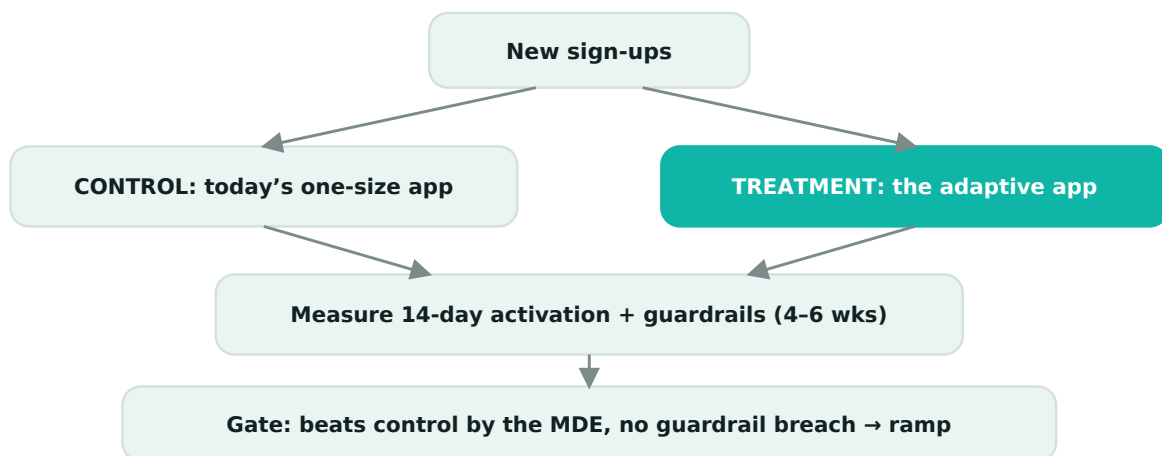
Does it work? Metrics and an A/B test

North Star — Weekly Active Earning Creators: people who make at least one converting share a week. It only counts if they shared (engagement) and it converted (GMV). Above it sits the business outcome: creator-attributed GMV per week.

Each segment gets a leading indicator that its hero change should move:

- Broadcaster → posts per active day, and how fast a hot deal gets posted.
- Influencer → conversion rate per link, and share of posts using the story kit.
- Home Earner → 14-day activation and the share of creators who hit their goal.

Guardrails (must not break): conversion rate per link, spam/unsubscribe and partner complaints, payout tickets. The counter-metric we watch hardest: clicks that don't convert must not rise — that's noise, not value.



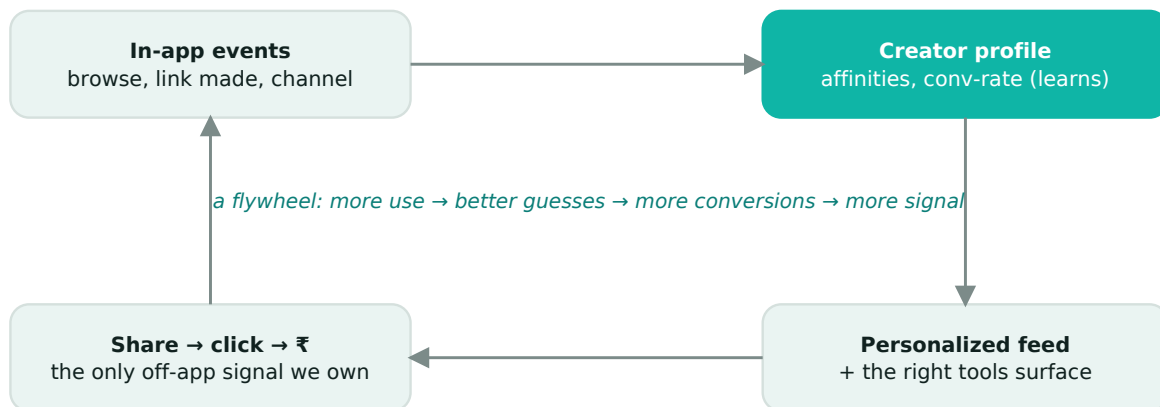
The experiment

- Test: the adaptive experience (soft onboarding → adaptive home + default share tool) vs. today's one-size app.
- Control: the current app — generic home, paste-a-link tool, no onboarding question.
- Randomise: by creator, at sign-up. New users give the cleanest read; existing users have habits that would muddy it.
- Primary metric: % of new creators with a converting share within 14 days. Roughly a 25% baseline; to catch a +2.5pp lift at 80% power needs about 4,800 creators per arm — run 4-6 weeks.
- A meaningful result: primary beats control by the MDE ($p < 0.05$), no guardrail breach, and the per-segment indicators move the right way — proof it's personalization, not a novelty bump.

One honest extension: the biggest GMV upside is in existing power users, so a second test runs a creator-level holdback on them — measuring sustained week-4 behaviour (to net out novelty) and watching for GMV simply shifting between creators. New-users = the clean read; existing-users = the value read.

The data engine that makes it smarter

Start with the constraint that makes EarnKaro special — and that most answers miss. Creators share links out to WhatsApp, Telegram and Instagram, where EK cannot see impressions, audiences, or engagement. We only see two things: what happens in-app, and the click-then-conversion when a buyer comes back through the link. The signal is sparse and one-sided — so the model has to be designed around it.



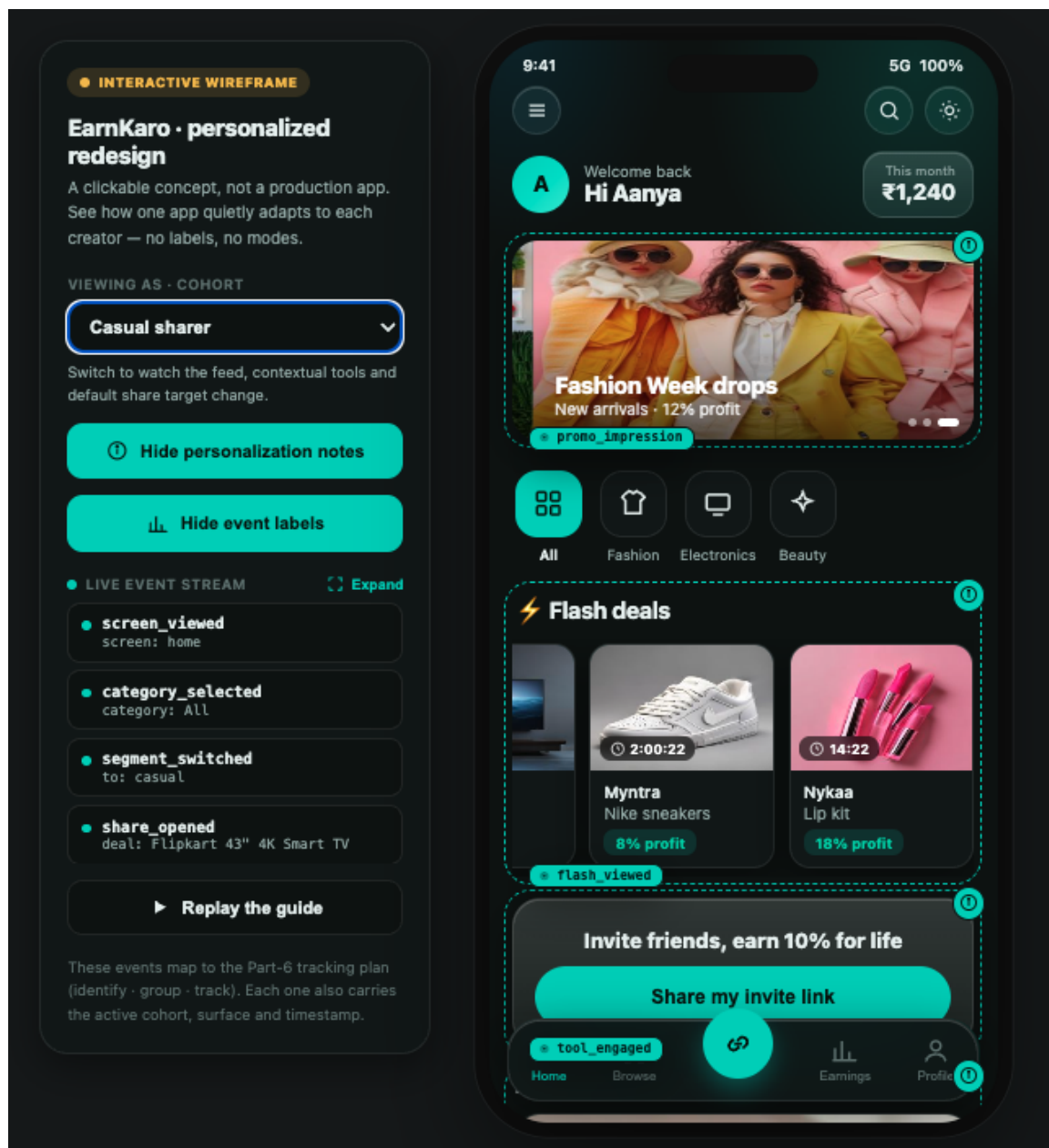
So we lean on what we own: in-app browsing and affinity, the creator’s link-creation choices (which brand, category, and — crucially — which channel they pushed to), and the click-to-conversion outcome of every link. The channel a creator shares to is our best off-platform proxy: we may not see the group, but we know where they sell. A neat side-effect: the more we pull sharing into in-app surfaces (the story card, the post composer), the more of the funnel we recapture.

The data model

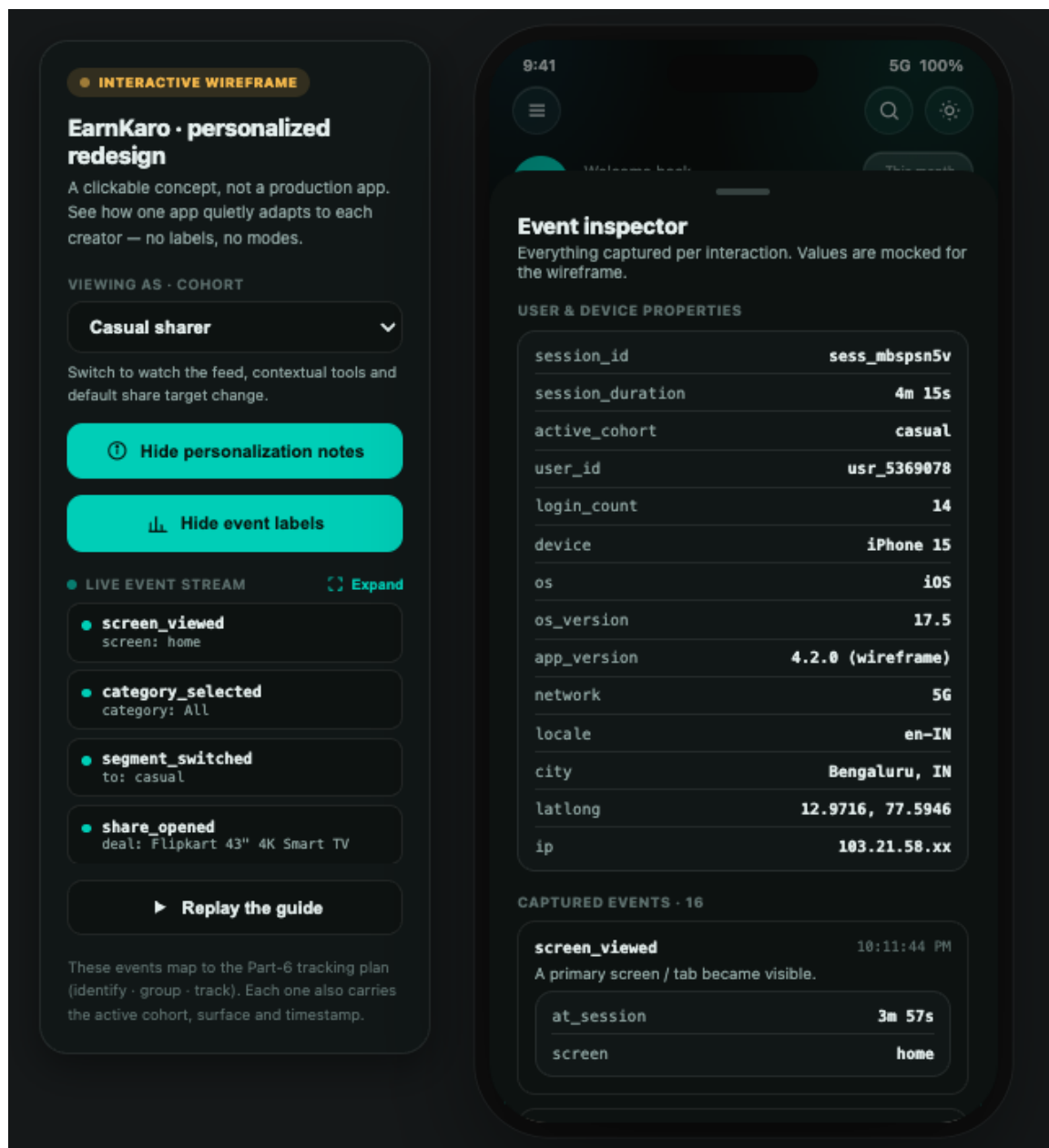
- Creator — declared signal, plus an inferred segment with a confidence score, language, channels, goal.
- Creator feature profile (the part that learns) — category and brand affinities, channel mix, personal conversion rate, active hours. Recomputed on every interaction; it’s the bridge between raw events and what the feed ranks.
- Deal, Brand, Link, Outcome, Referral, Event — the supporting objects and the append-only event log.

How it improves with each interaction: the onboarding answer is just a prior. If Sahil ticks “Casual” but then posts 80 deals a day to a 20k group, behaviour overrides the label and he’s re-scored toward Broadcaster — his home and tools shift with him. Early on we serve the segment template; as the profile fills, ranking moves from “what Broadcasters like” to “what this creator converts.” Rules run it today; ML (learning-to-rank, conversion-propensity) earns its place once the log beats the rules.

We made this tangible: the prototype fires real events and shows them live, with a full inspector of everything captured per interaction.



Every section is tagged with the event it emits, and the live stream logs them as you tap — the tracking plan, made visible.



The event inspector: per-event detail plus the user and device properties we'd capture (session, device, OS, city, lat/long, IP).

Risks we'd watch

- Filter bubble. Over-personalising narrows the feed. Keep a few exploration slots so creators still discover new categories.
- Cold start and sparse signal. Early guesses are weak (see Part 6). Lean on the declared signal and safe defaults until confidence is high.
- Over-fitting to the past. Audiences shift; decay old signal so last month doesn't trap a creator forever.
- Fairness to brands. Ranking can starve mid-tail deals. Add a brand-diversity guardrail so the catalogue doesn't collapse to a few winners.
- Trust, for the Home Earner. Wrong picks erode trust fastest for the most cautious segment. Stay conservative and always show "why you're seeing this."

In one line

Five segments, one app, no labels. The home, the discovery, and the sharing all bend to who you are — a Broadcaster gets speed, an Influencer gets taste, a Home Earner gets a goal — and a sparse-but-honest data loop makes every one of those guesses a little better next week.

APPENDIX

- Prototype: interactive React app — onboarding into five adaptive homes, divergent share flows, light/dark, and a live event stream. A hidden "simulate profile" control lets a reviewer watch the same app re-personalize (not a user feature).
- On the numbers: segment sizes and the A/B baseline are explicit estimates, to be replaced with EarnKaro's own data.